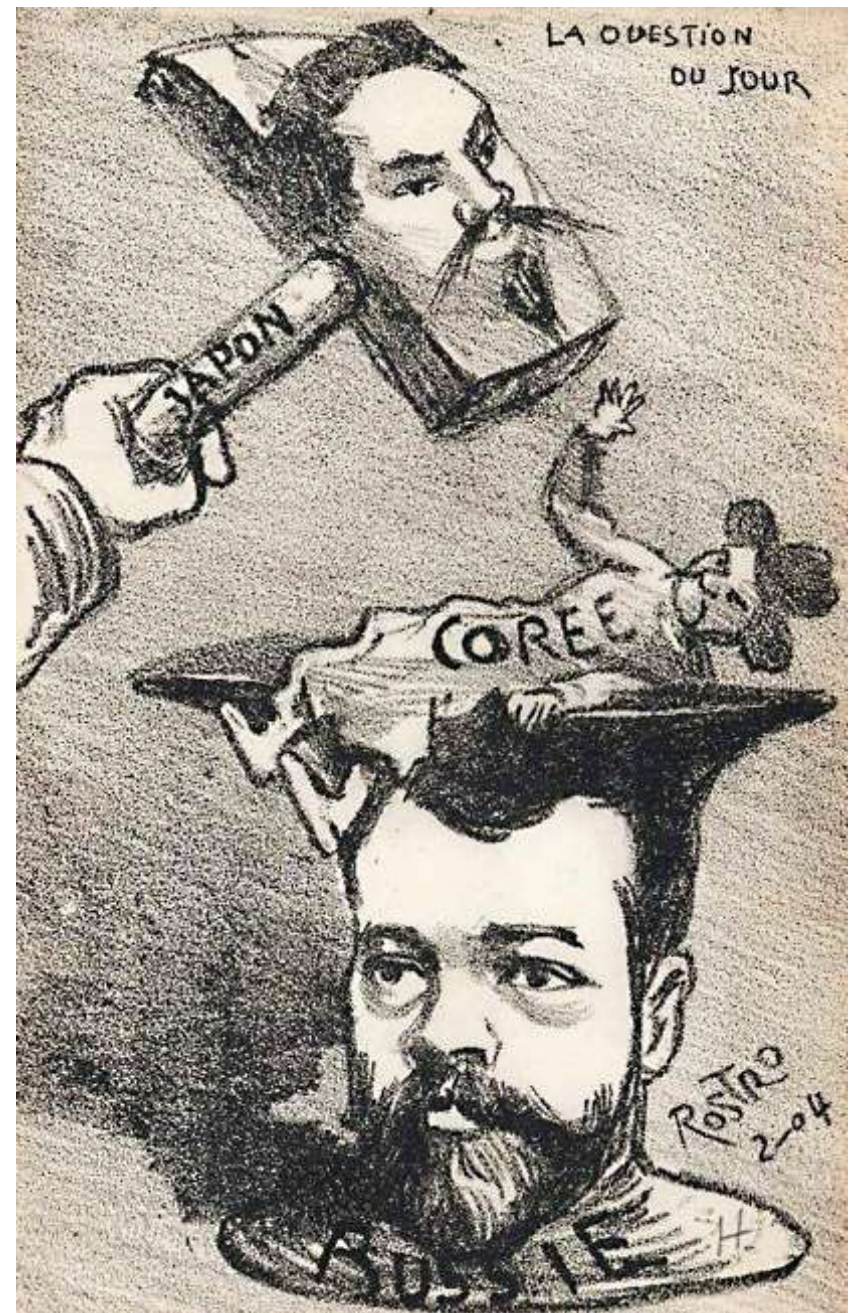


June 25, 1950: North Korea invades South Korea



A Little Background

Japan occupies Korea,
Russo-Japanese War,
1904-05



French cartoon, 1904

From Korea,
Japanese march
to Manchuria
(1931) and then
deep into China
(1937).





After VJ Day

USSR troops →

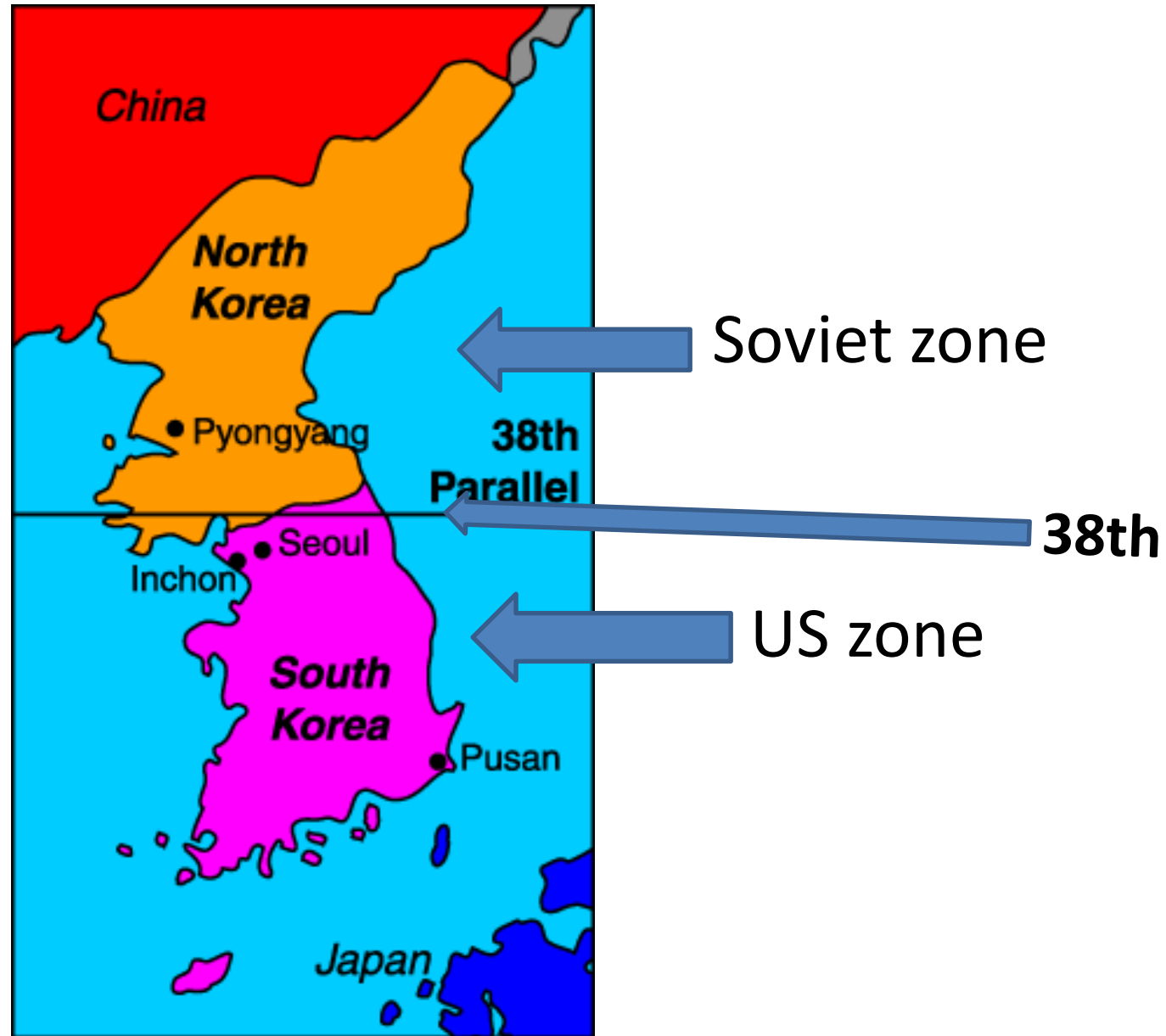


US occupied Japan,
but shared burden

- In China
- In Indochina
- In Korea

At VJ Day, US divided Korea at 38th parallel:

This division
is temporary
and
arbitrary.



1945 & 1946 & 1947:
The cement hardens.
The Cold War deepens



The division of N. & S. Korea hardens

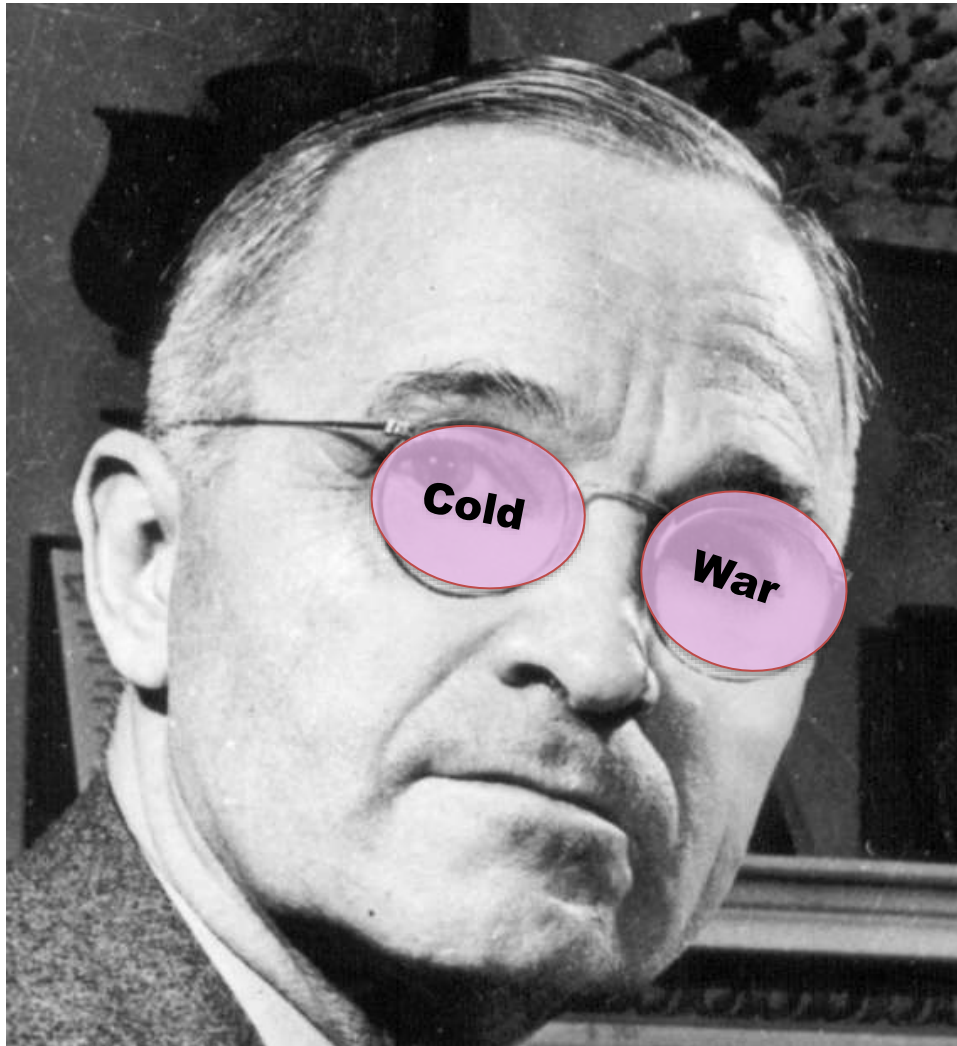
Pro-US Syngmann **Rhee** is
in charge of South Korea



Pro-USSR **Kim il Sung** is
in charge of North Korea



June 25, 1950, when N. Korea invades S. Korea,
HST sees it through “Cold War glasses.”



Truman's assumptions about N Korea's attack on S Korea



Kennan's containment

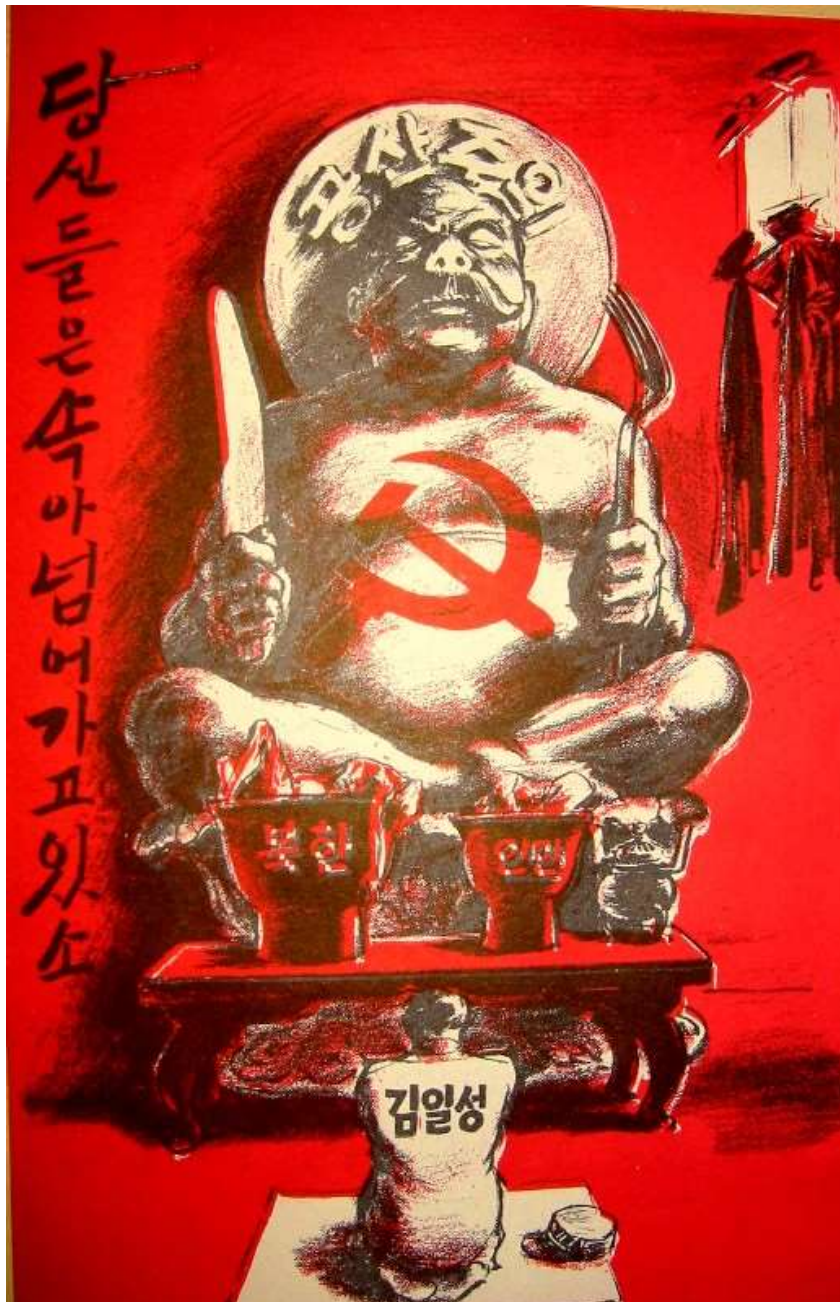


Nitze's NSC 68



McCarthyism

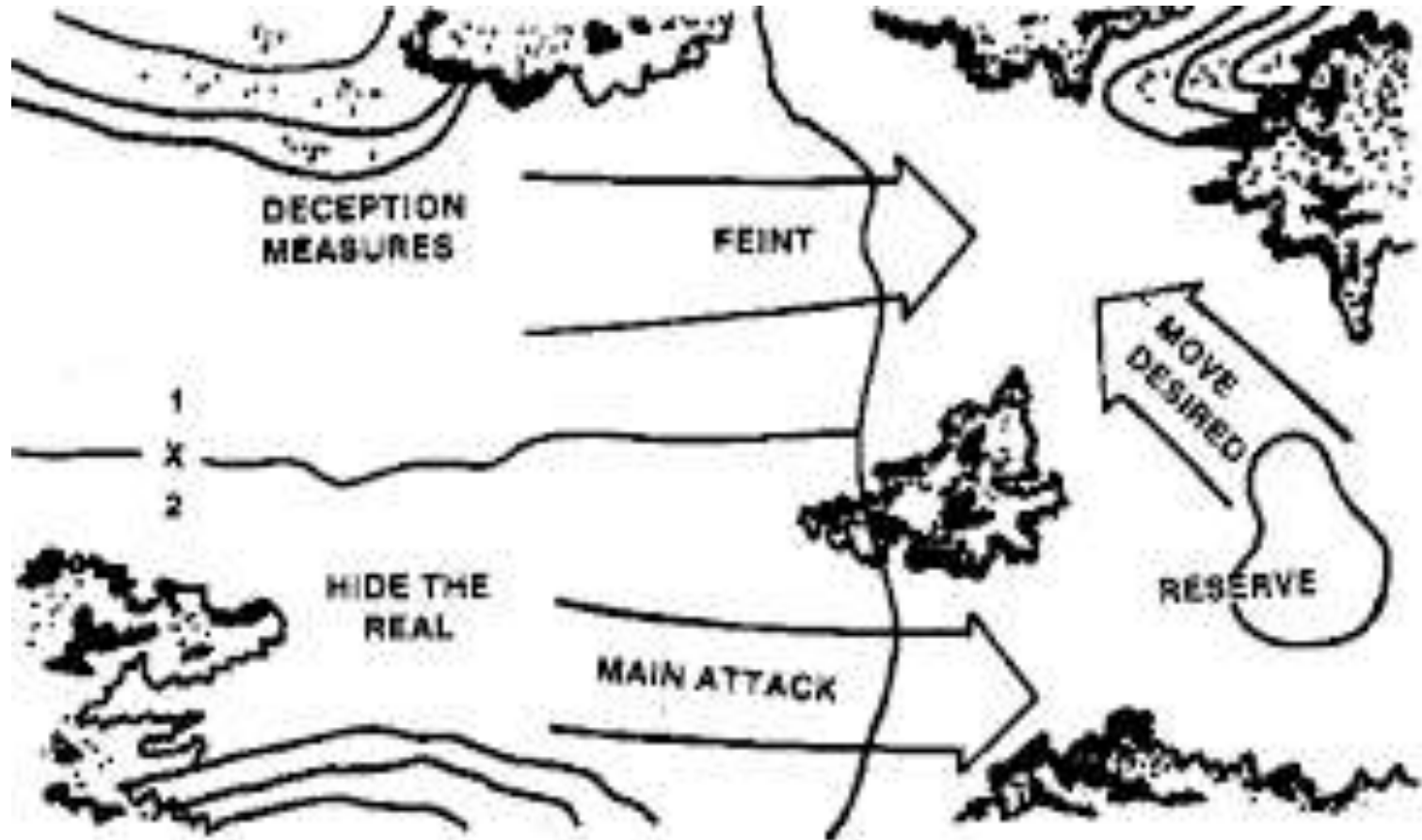




This is a
Soviet
threat!

A Korean prays to
Stalin, as Buddha

Moreover, it was unlikely the Soviets were really interested in S. Korea



West Berlin must be the real target!



Therefore, HST immediately

- (1) Sends US Air & Navy to defend South Korea & CONTAIN the USSR



(2) Increases US aid to French in Indochina



(3) Sends 7th
fleet to defend
Taiwan/
Formosa



HST goes to the UN to get its backing for war -- wanted to strengthen UN



HST and UN,
carrying
weapon, rush
over the grave
of League of
Nations: *“Died
for lack of
exercise facing
wanton
aggression”*

UN Security Council

(dominated by USA)

- authorizes “UN Coalition,” led by USA, to go to war
flags of all countries in coalition →
- to restore “Status quo ante.”

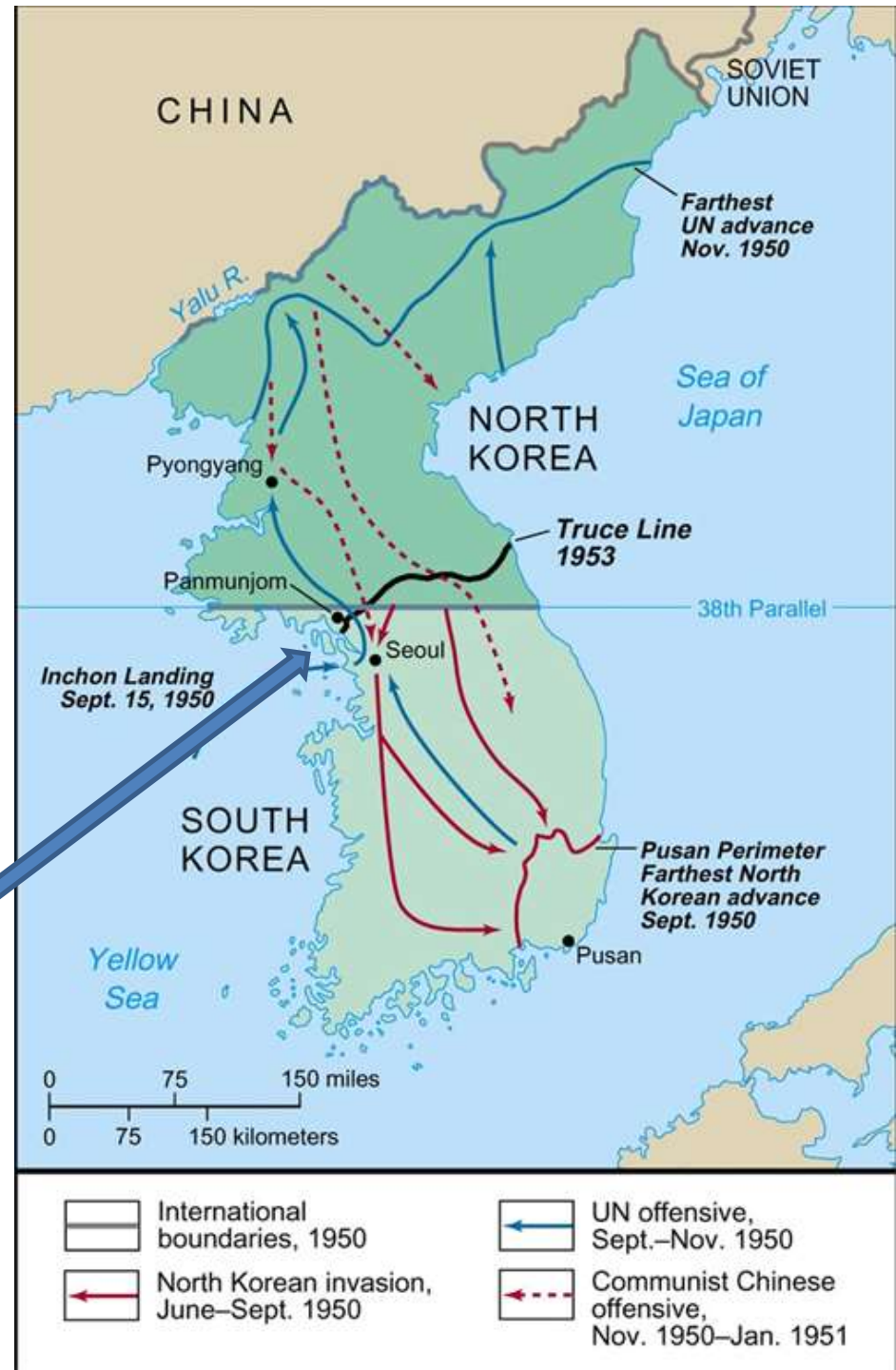


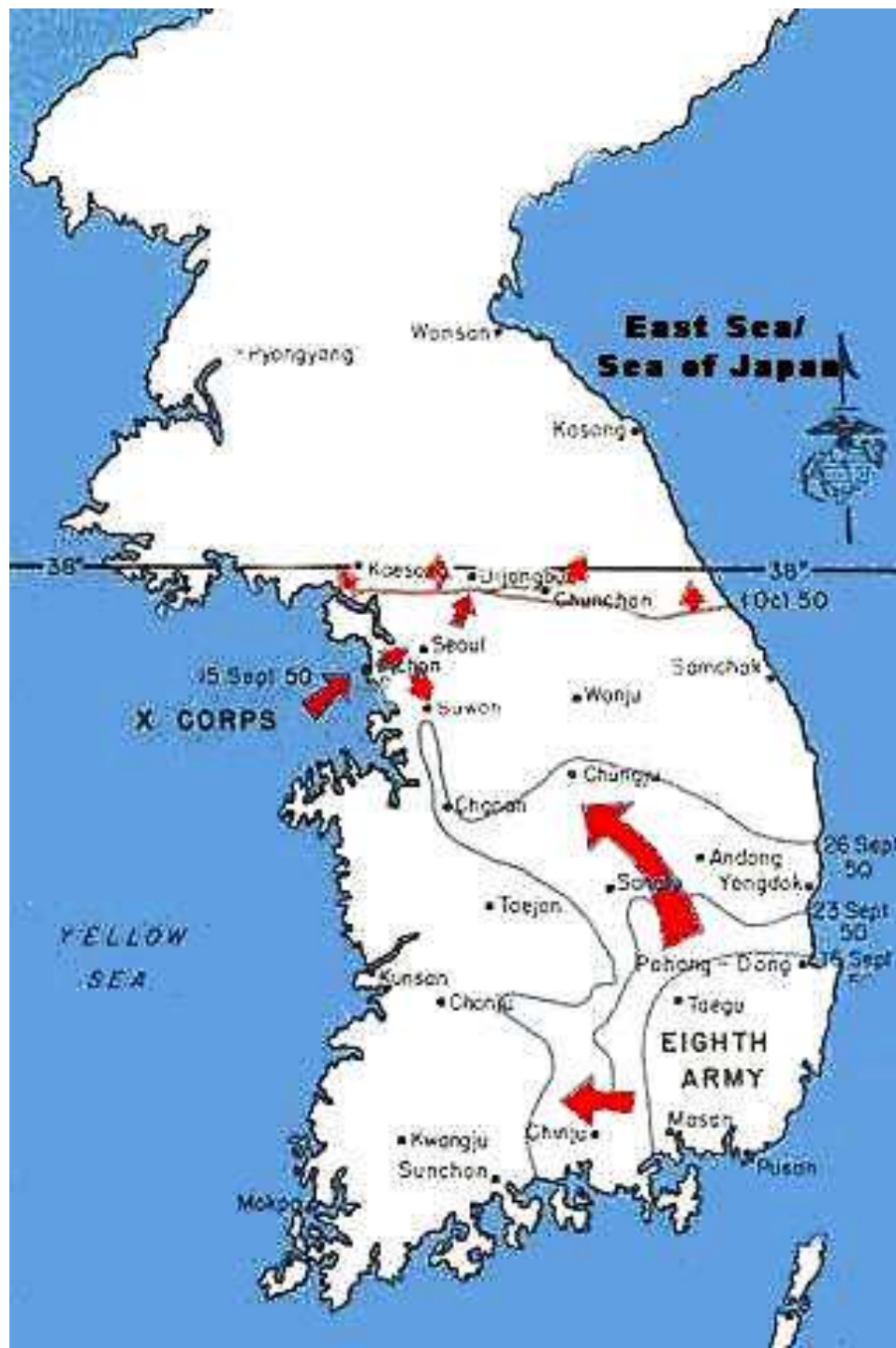
US/UN setbacks June-Sept. 1950



US/UN
pushed to
“Pusan
Perimeter”

MacArthur lands at Inchon, behind enemy lines





This helps to turn
tide of war

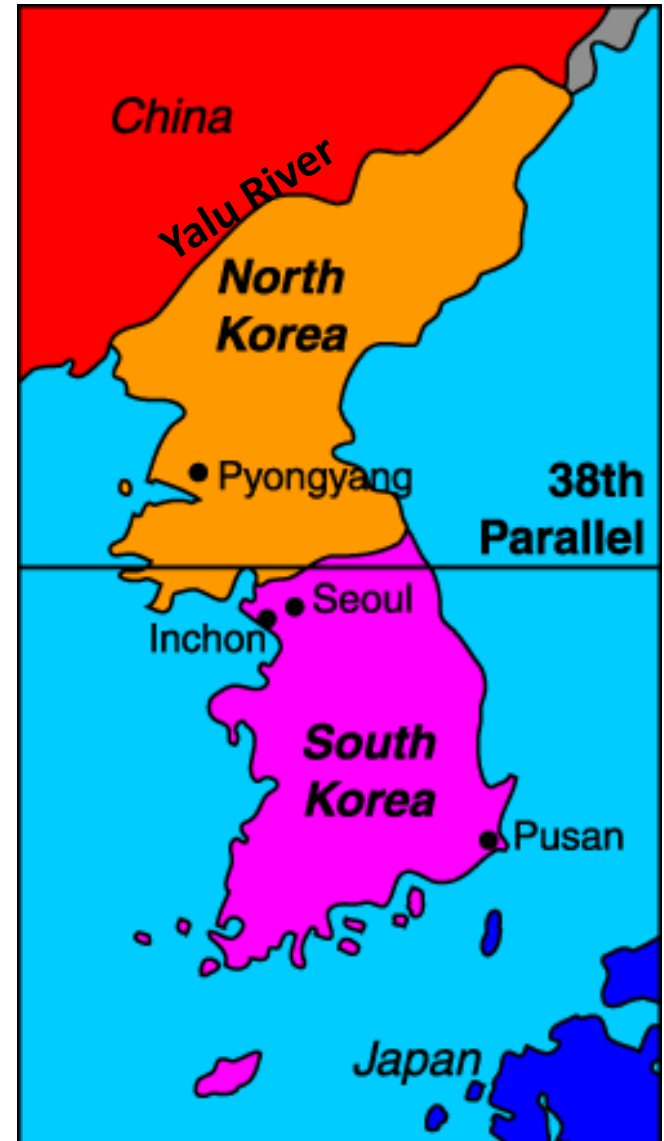
Sept-Oct. 1950:
US/UN breaks
out of “Pusan
Perimeter” and
marches toward
38th

October 1950: HST has to decide:
To cross or not to cross?

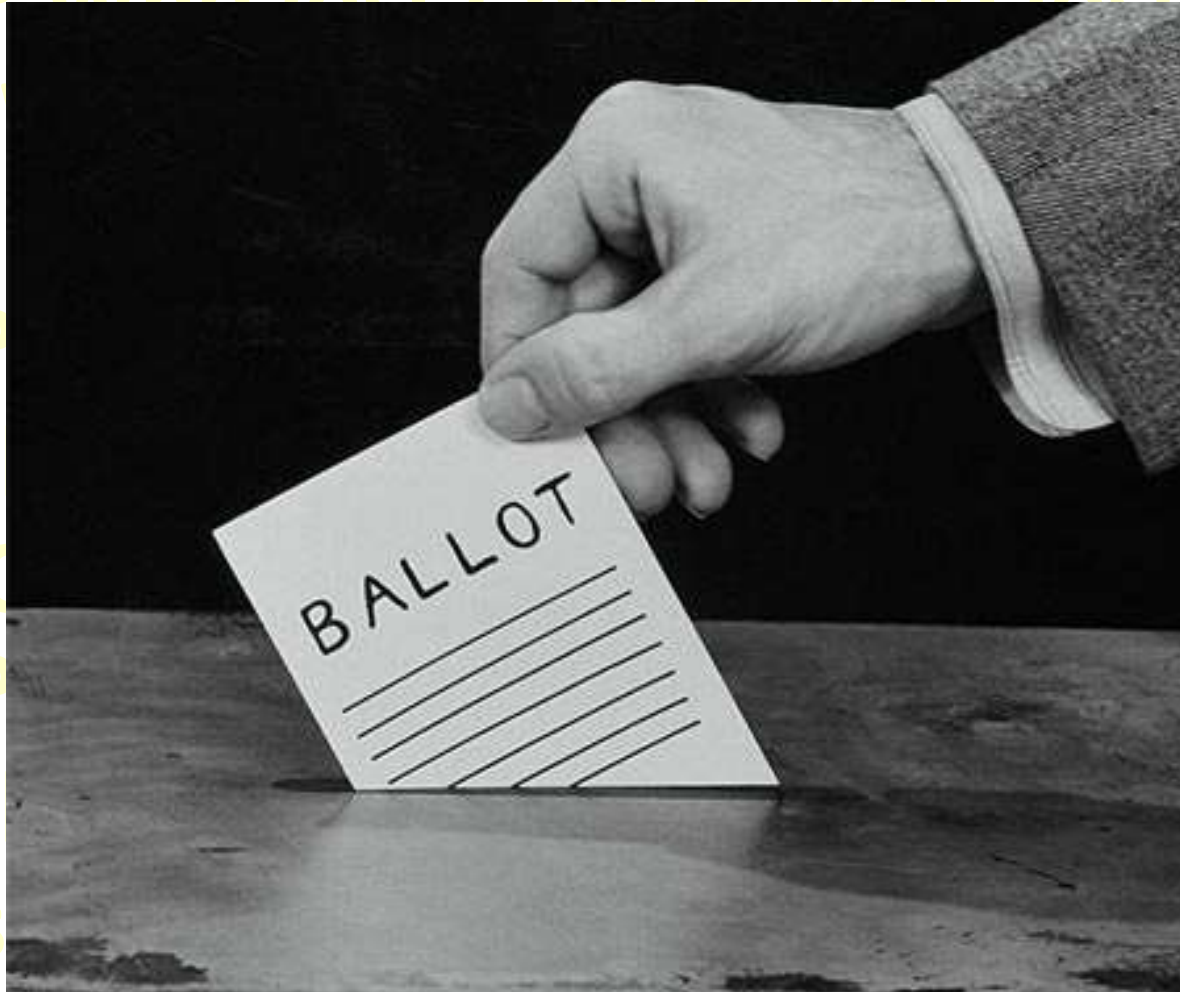


Arguments **against** crossing 38th

- Might bring Chinese into war
- Change of UN sanctioned war aims (status quo ante)
- From containment to “rollback”



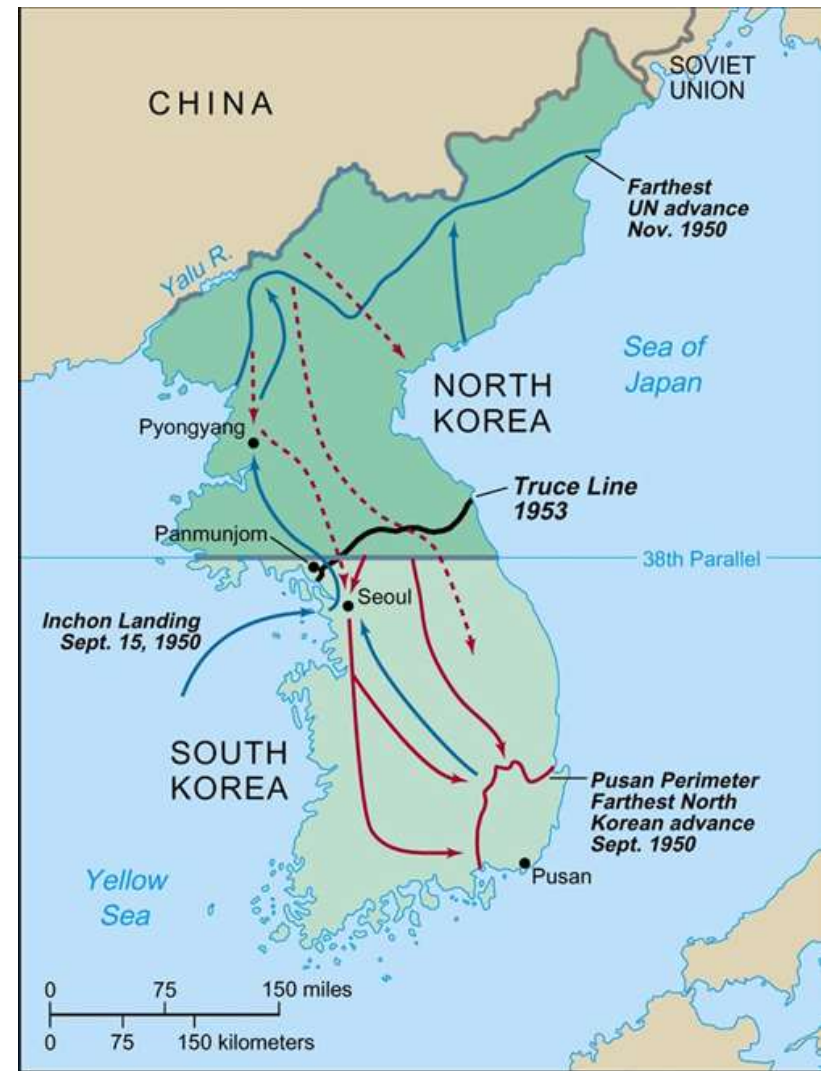
Arguments for crossing 38th: The 3 Ms



Midterm elections

Arguments for crossing 38th: The 3 Ms

MOMENTUM!



Arguments for crossing 38th: The 3 Ms



MacArthur

- Hero of WW2
- Occupier of Japan
- Hero of Inchon

MacArthur assures HST that China will NOT intervene

- China is too weak
- Mao will trust US assurances to stop at Yalu River



Truman decides to cross the 38th US/UN troops roll to the Yalu

38th parallel



BUT ...

Nov. 1950: The Chinese enter the war





200,000 Chinese
fight in Korea.
They force the
longest US
retreat in history.

Why did Mao enter the war?



Was he pushed by Stalin?



An American propaganda leaflet to undermine Chinese morale

New evidence shows that **Kim – not Stalin and not Mao – wanted war**



Kim il-Sung in Moscow

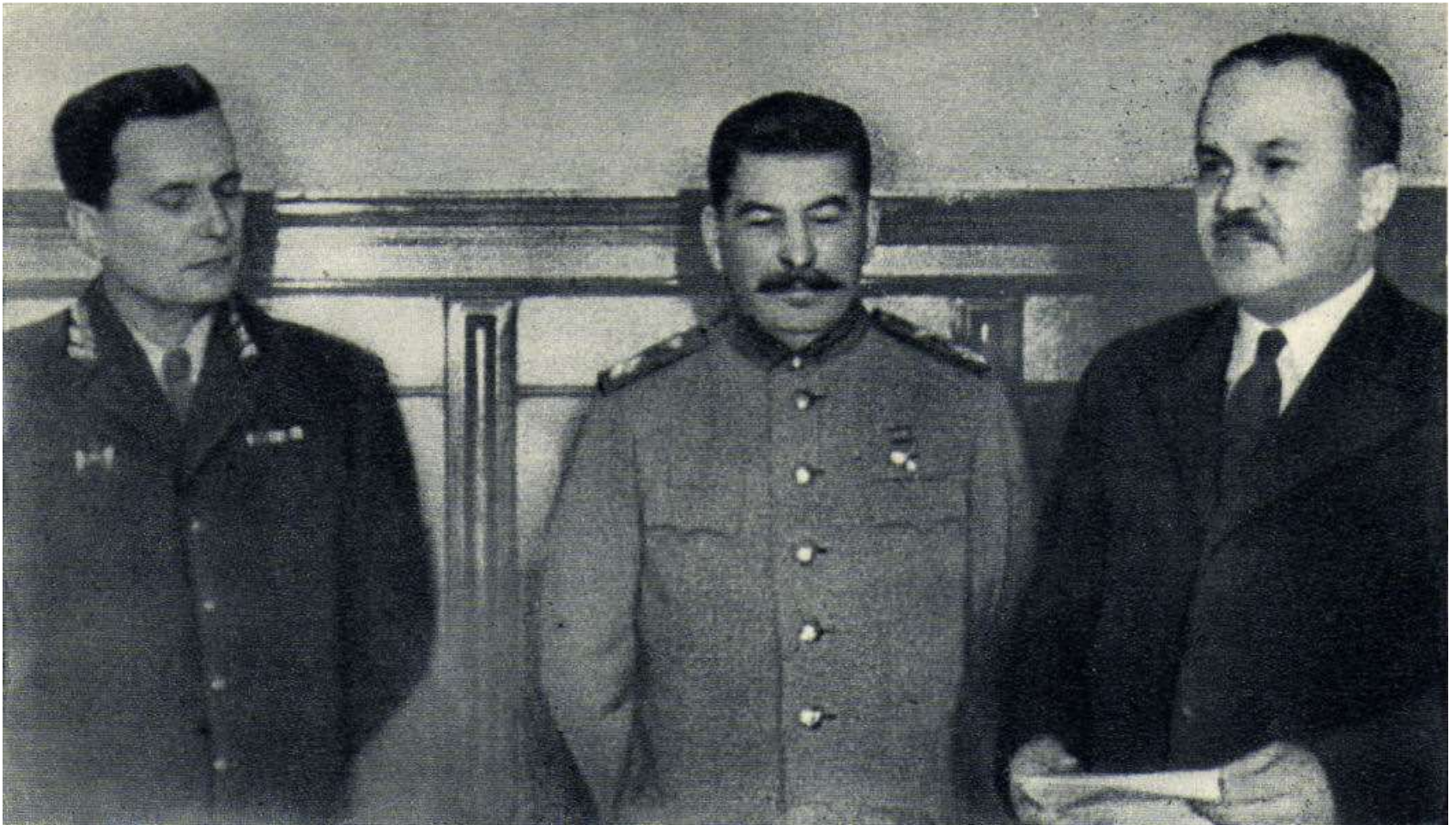
He pleaded with Stalin to support war to reunite Korea.

Stalin finally said, “OK,” and told Kim to inform Mao.

What was
Stalin's
obsession in
the late 1940s?

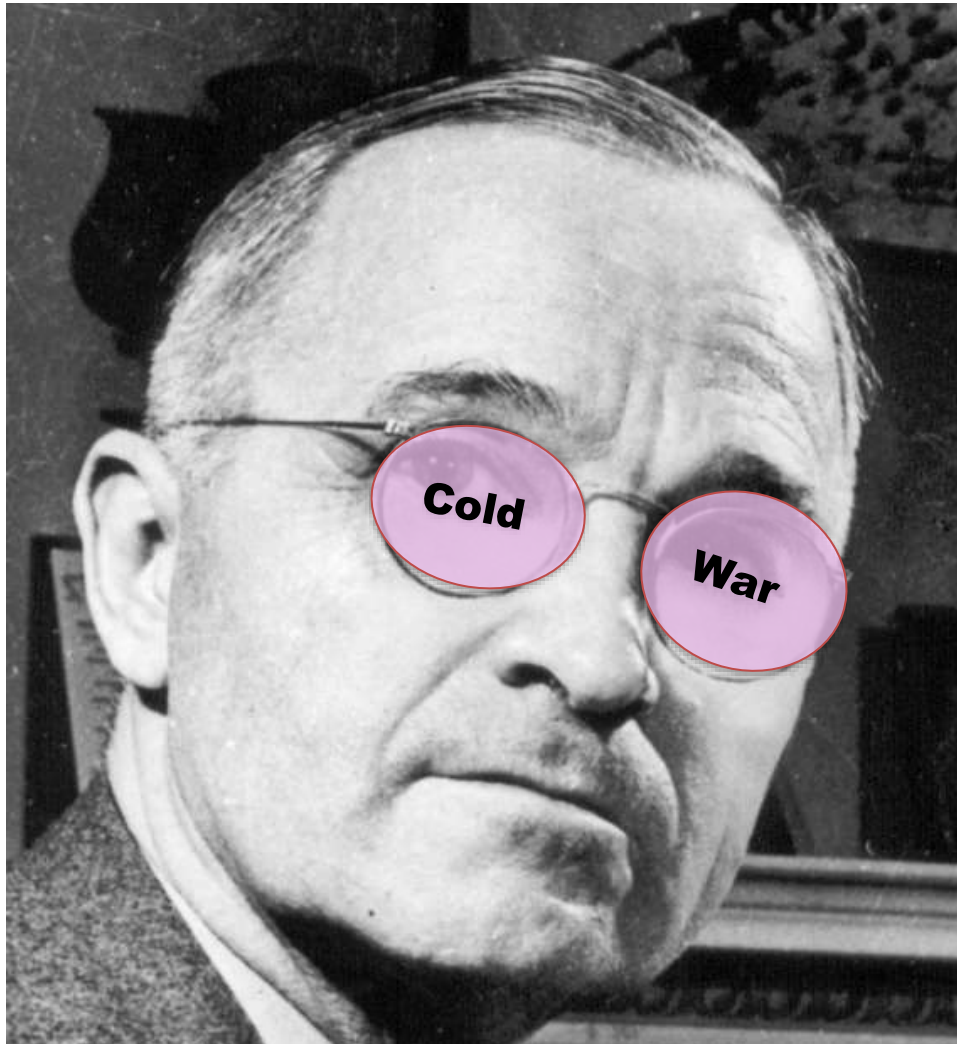


Tito, Stalin Split, May 1948



Tito, Stalin, Molotov

Truman's "Cold War glasses" distorted reality



This cartoon should be changed:
Kim pushed Stalin, and this pushed Mao



MacArthur publically criticizes HST's policy



- He wants to bomb China.
- He says he's fighting with one arm tied behind his back

The Weather

Temperature, relative to observer at
10:40, high about 60. Precipitation
will shower in evening. Temperature
high, 58 at 4:30 p. m.; low, 47 at 10:40
p. m. Climate on Page C11.1

The Washington Post

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TRUMAN FIRES M'ARTHUR

April 1951

Asserts civilian control of military



War settles into a stalemate.

The “accordion war” 1951,1952, 1953



The war grinds on

It is during this period that M*A*S*H takes place.



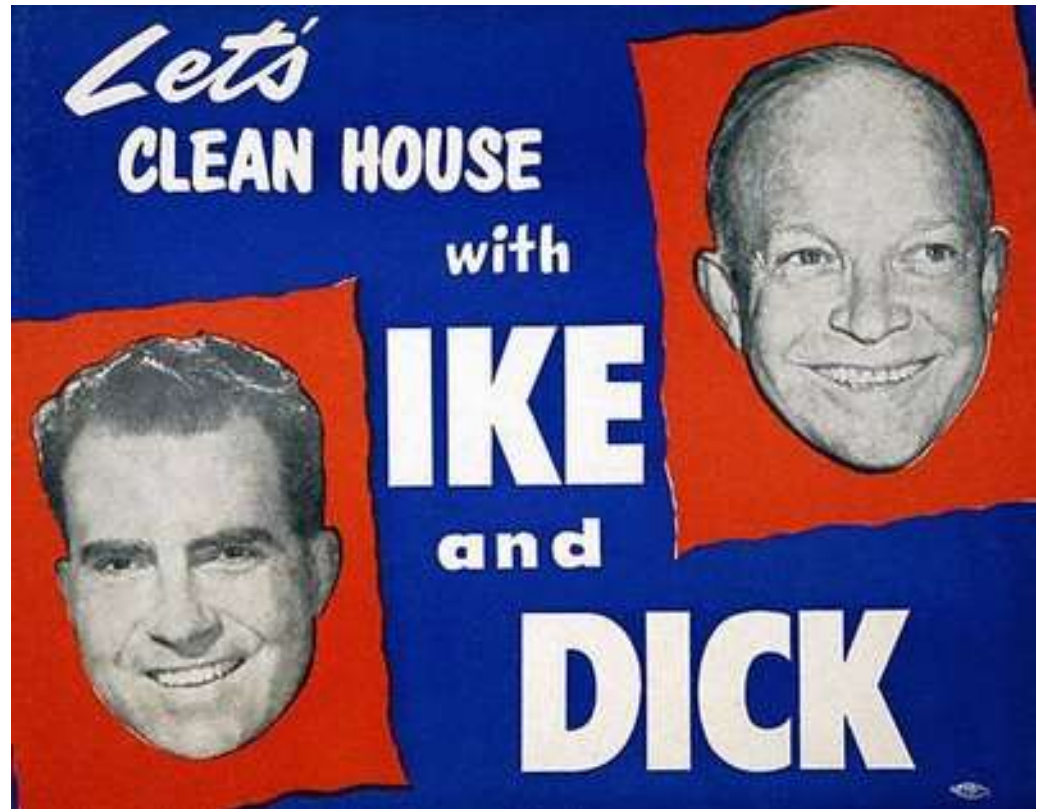
Election of 1952:

Democrats called “weak on defense”

HST blamed for

- Iron Curtain
- USSR bomb
- “loss” of China
- Korean War

McCarthy on warpath



Eisenhower promises:

- “I will go to Korea!”
- Rollback!
- Lower taxes

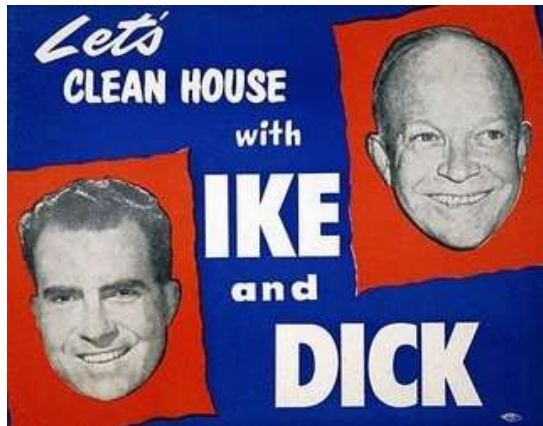
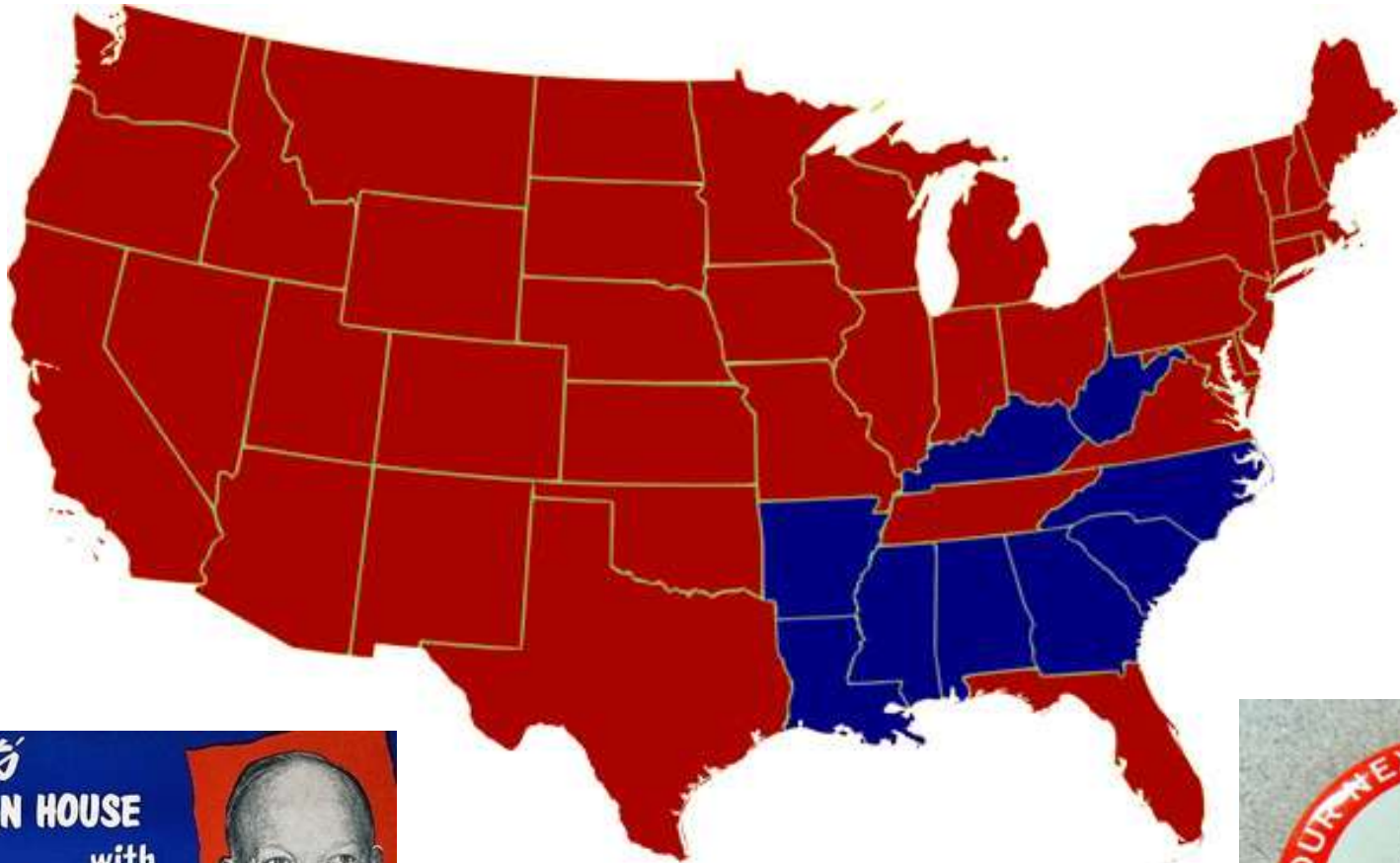


Ike did not denounce McCarthy



And they appeared together on the campaign

Landslide!

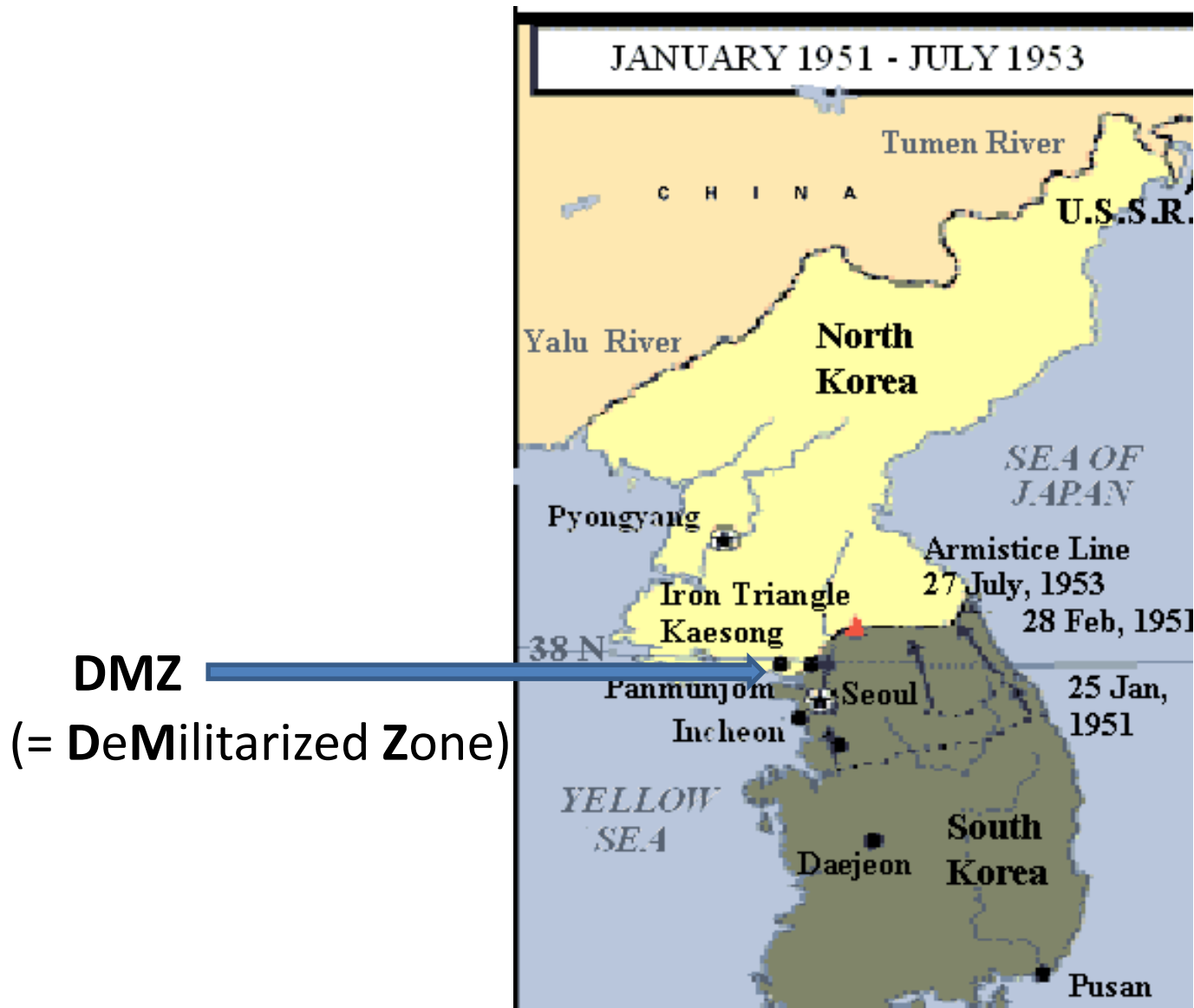


Ike's Foreign Policy: Korea



March 1953: Stalin dies.
The Kremlin decides to end the war in Korea

July 27, 1953: Armistice

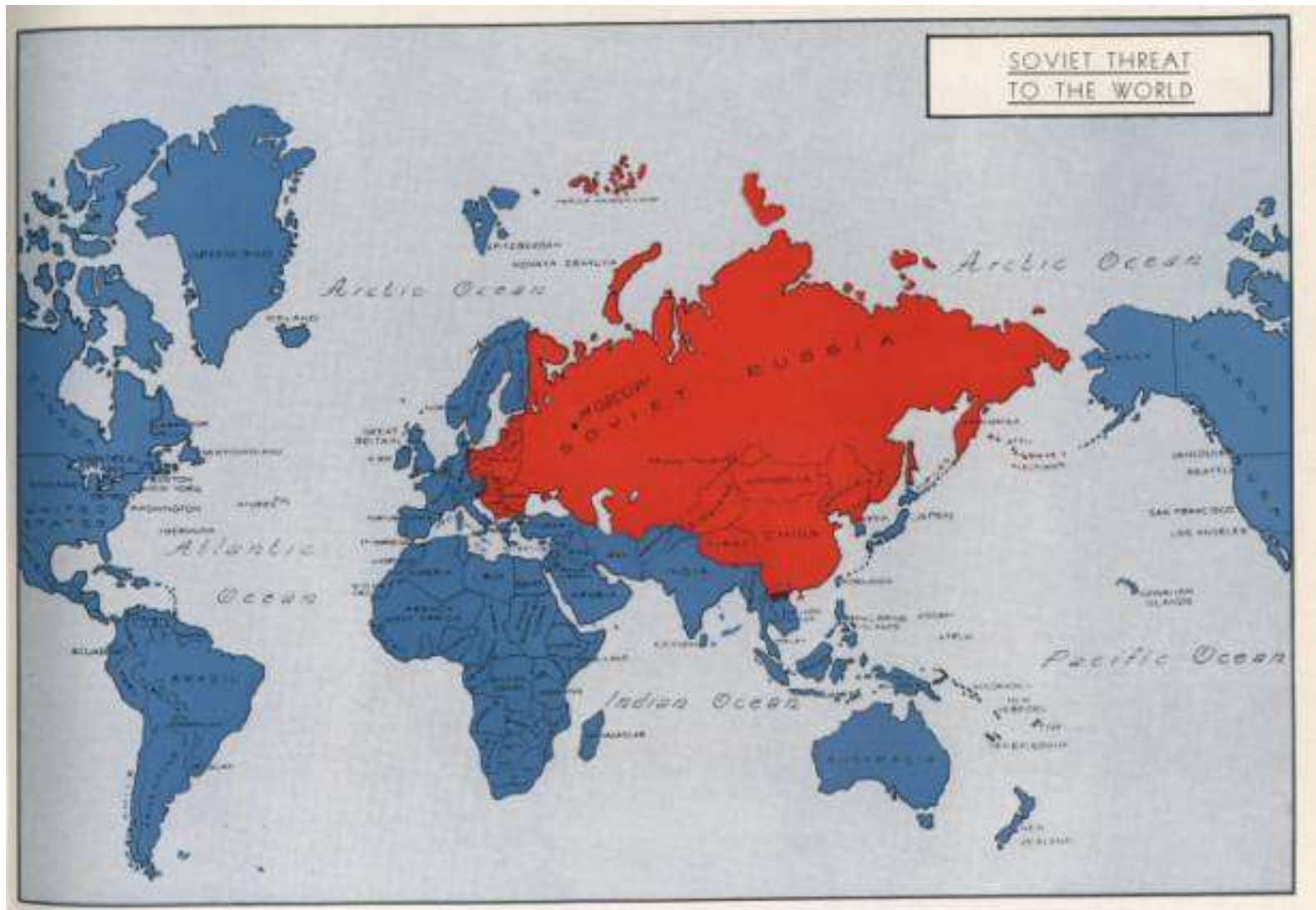


Impact of Korean War: Casualties

USA	55,000
China	at least 300,000
Korea	ca. 2,000,000



Impact of Korean War: containment is globalized



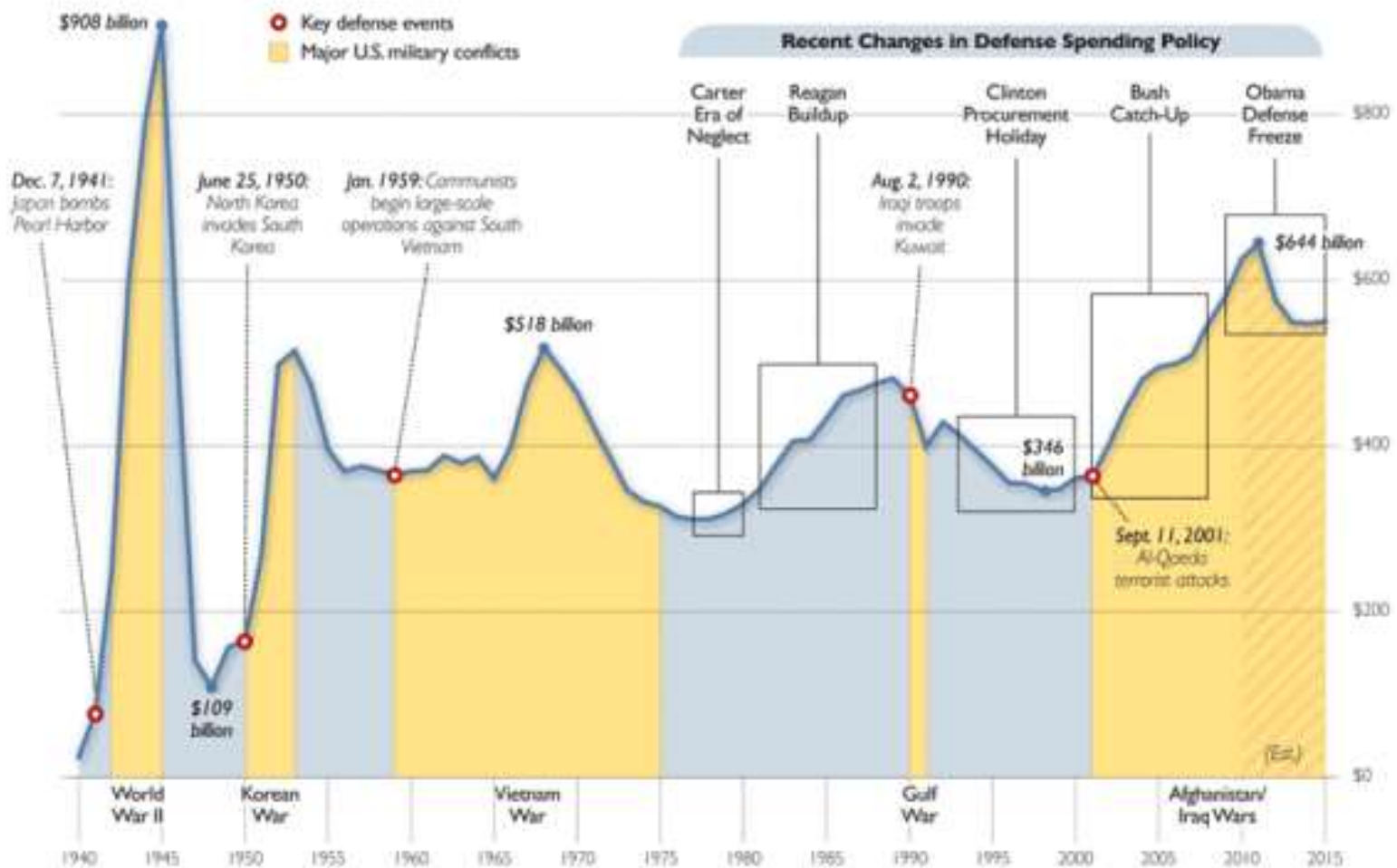
Impact of Korean War:

No US relations with China until 1970s



- US insisted Taiwan was the TRUE government of “China.”
- US had no relations with “Red” China.

Impact of Korean War: US sense of communist threat expands greatly



Defense spending spiked 300%

Impact of Korean War: NSC 68 adopted



The “Super” is developed

Impact of Korean War: CIA given more power



July 1948

